Jenna McArdle

1st Year Immersive Software Engineering Student · University of Limerick · Seeking a placement from June 2027

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Profile

First-year software engineering student with hands-on experience in Java, Python, CI/CD and AWS from project-based modules. I enjoy turning large problems into simple, user-friendly solutions, with a particular interest in UI/UX and accessibility. Looking for a placement from June 2027 to contribute to a real codebase and explore areas such as fintech and microelectronics.

Technical Skills

- **Languages:** Java, Python, HTML/CSS, JavaScript (Node.js)
- **Testing & quality:** Unit and integration testing, BDD with Playwright & Cucumber, ESLint
- **DevOps & cloud:** Git & GitHub, GitHub Actions (CI/CD), Docker, AWS (ECS, ECR, EC2, S3, CloudFront, CloudFormation, CloudWatch)
- **Tools & environments:** VS Code, IntelliJ, Linux command line, PowerShell
- **Practices:** Architecture Decision Records (ADRs), PR protection and code review, SLIs/SLOs and health probes

Projects

Astro Recipe Blog — DevOps module, solo · Sept 2026 · GitHub *Astro, Node.js, Docker, AWS ECS, GitHub Actions, Playwright, Cucumber*

- Built and deployed a dynamic blog as a Docker image on Amazon ECS, using ECR, S3, CloudFront and CloudFormation.
- Wrote unit, integration and end-to-end BDD tests, wired into a CI pipeline that blocks failing pull requests.
- Wrote an ADR to justify moving from static deployment to server-side rendering.

- Added liveness health probes and CloudWatch monitoring based on SLI/SLO principles.

Verbose Fetch — Computer Organisation module, team of 4 · Oct 2026 · GitHub *Java, Linux*

- Co-developed a Java CLI tool that inspects and reports hardware and CPU data on Linux systems.
- Built features to list PCI devices sorted alphabetically and by bus/device/function.
- Benchmarked a CPU-heavy task on 1, 2, 4+ threads and compared real speedup with Amdahl's law.
- Reported CPU model, core count and per-core load sampled over one second.

Personal Portfolio Website — solo · Nov 2026 · Live site *HTML, CSS, GitHub Pages*

- Designed, wrote and deployed a responsive portfolio site with a mobile layout, hosted on GitHub Pages.

Education

BSc/MSc Immersive Software Engineering, University of Limerick · Sept 2026 – present

- Project-based programme. Modules so far include DevOps, Java and Computer Organisation.

Leaving Certificate, Mount Mercy College, Cork · 2020 – 2026

- 625 points (maximum). H1s in Mathematics, Physics, Accounting, Business, French and Irish; 100% in French.
- Peer- and principal-nominated Deputy Head Girl, class of 2026.

Experience

Sales Team Member, Life Style Sports, Cork · Jul – Sept 2026

- Worked 5 days a week in a high-volume store, consistently meeting daily sales targets.
- Handled POS transactions, returns and exchanges accurately on Microsoft Store Commerce.
- Communicated clearly with customers and colleagues under pressure during peak periods.

Work Experience, University College Cork (APC building) · Transition Year

- Automated the creation of staff email lists from Excel spreadsheets, making mail-outs more efficient.
- Described by manager as "well able" and "a pleasure to have around the office".

Earlier part-time roles in hospitality and customer service (2022 – 2024).

Achievements & Interests

- **Swimming:** Competitive swimmer for over a decade, training up to 15 hours a week from 5am. Youngest ever female winner of the 2023 Cork Lee Swim; represented Munster at the 2023 Irish Senior Schools Interprovincials.
- **Industry engagement:** Attended "50 Years of Analog Devices" talk (Sept 2026); completed Boot.dev Python course.
- **Languages:** English (native), Irish (fluent), French (Advanced). Member of Cumann Gaelach UL.
- **Interests:** Fintech, microelectronics, accessible UI/UX, guitar.